
**Unit 1, Option B,
Topic B5: Conflict
and Conquest in
Ireland, 1598-1692**

The focus of this topic is the process by which English (and Scottish) occupation of Ireland became a reality beyond the Pale. Since the focus of this unit is on broad themes, questions will not be set which focus exclusively on depth of knowledge, for example about one particular individual or event, other than those which are specifically listed in the specification bullet points. Students will, however, be expected to demonstrate their understanding of the themes defined in the specification bullet points by the selection and deployment of relevant information as exemplification.

The bullet points should not each be considered in isolation. Collectively, they offer a framework for understanding the broad themes of conquest and control, resistance and its price, and the extent to which Ireland was subordinated to English and Scottish interests and those of different monarchs. These elements are built up by considering the links between the bullet points as well as the interaction of developments within them.

The first bullet point addresses the last years of Elizabeth I and the Tyrone rebellion. Students should understand why rebellion broke out and why Elizabeth faced difficulty in suppressing the rebellion. They can refer to the leadership offered by the earls, the impact of religion and the threat of Spain as well as the failure of Essex. There should be some understanding of the methods by which Mountjoy re-established English authority and of their impact on Irish attitudes. Questions will not be asked that require detailed knowledge of military campaigns but the nature and outcome of the rebellion and its significance for Anglo-Irish relations should be understood.

The second bullet point addresses the impact of new links between England and Scotland and the implications of the Stuart accession. Students should also understand the plantation policy, and in particular the plantation of Ulster. Key outcomes of this include the effect on the Irish population, on patterns of landholding and on the relationship between different religions in Ireland. Students should have a broad understanding of these and some awareness of how tensions increased under Charles I and Strafford. Questions will not be asked that require detailed knowledge of any single individual or event. The focus of this bullet point is on the impact of the settlement, the changing nature of English authority and the ways in which tensions were created.

The third bullet point focuses on the Confederate War, 1641-53, and on the effects felt by the Irish population. Students should understand links between the rebellion in Ulster in 1641, the course of the war in Ireland, and the re-conquest of Ireland in 1649-53. They are not required to have detailed knowledge of military campaigns but should be able to exemplify factional rivalries and their impact on attitudes. They should have knowledge and understanding of the role of Ormond. They should consider the extent of hostility by 1649 and the role of Oliver Cromwell, with some awareness of the accuracy of different claims and counter-claims. They should understand the main features of the land settlement that followed and of its impact on the Irish population.

The final bullet point focuses on the restored Stuarts, the nature of Restoration government in Ireland, and the economic relationships that developed as English trade and colonial power expanded. Students should understand the extent to which Ireland was neglected and Irish hopes disappointed by the Restoration settlement and government under both the Protestant Ormond and the Catholic Tyrconnell. They should be aware of the flight of James II and the Glorious Revolution in England but their main focus should be its impact in Ireland. Detailed knowledge of the war between James and William of Orange and the campaign of 1690 and its outcome is not required, but students should have broad understanding of its significance for Ireland and of the impact of the revolution settlement on Ireland.